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FAREWELL TO TROOPER



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

State troopers at St. James Church in Salem accompanied the casket of Kevin Trainor, who was killed last week by a wrong-way driver. Wednesday's funeral was attended by thousands of law enforcement officials from across the region. **B1.**

Despite court ruling, tenure still at risk on campuses

Tufts professors fear more salary cuts ahead

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

When Amy Yee earned tenure in 1998, it was a golden ticket.

Tufts Medical School offered her a coveted lifetime appointment as a professor in health sciences. In recognition of Yee's "innovative studies" and excellence in the field, Tufts agreed to pay her to teach classes and conduct research there in perpetuity, with virtually no constraints.

Two decades later, Yee and seven other Tufts Medical School professors sued the university for violating that promise of steady pay in their employment contracts. Then last month, they won.

To Yee, the "precedent-setting" ruling is a win for tenure and an affirmation of what universities owe their highest-ranking faculty. But it also reveals the fragility of an academic ideal that has become onerous for more and more schools struggling with financial pressures. While the battle plays out nationwide, the Tufts case stands out for its size and scope.

Colleges concerned with political scrutiny and their own bottom lines today are unwinding protections for experienced faculty. And though it's still uncommon for universities to strip tenure from professors entirely, fewer tenured faculty can rely on the financial stability

TENURE, Page A10

'Most of us drive well because we want to earn a living.'

FRANCIS AVALO, *delivery person*

Struggling delivery drivers wary of tighter moped rules

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

Sometimes, the toehold to the American dream looks like this: a row of guys in the heart of upper-crust Boston packing fried chicken onto the back of their mopeds in the rain.

In the Back Bay, it was a fairly typical and rather miserable spring evening. Rain was falling, making the pavement slick. The wind was whipping down the urban canyon of Boylston Street, turning some umbrellas inside out. And in those suboptimal conditions,

the men were getting ready to tool around on their mopeds to deliver food in one of the city's wealthiest neighborhoods during rush hour.

Across Greater Boston, food delivery on motorbikes has become so ubiquitous that some local politicians are aiming to tighten the rules that impact the men's line of work, with proposed restrictions ranging from limits on what kind of vehicles can operate in a bike lane to an outright ban on third-party motorbike food de-

MOPEDS, Page A7



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Moped drivers sometimes use crowded sidewalks and bike lanes to do their jobs, jeopardizing pedestrians.

SJC has call on ballot questions proceeding

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts voters could decide a record number of new laws this November. That is, if the state's highest court lets them.

Long before voters will head to the polls, the Supreme Judicial Court is acting as a gatekeeper of sorts for what ends up on the ballot in November, having already played a key role in knocking one measure out of contention while deliberating the legal fates of at least four more.

There are a total of 11 initiatives wending their way through the political process.

Of those, the court is weighing legal challenges to the one that would slash the state's income tax, and others that would repeal a ban on rent control, roll back recreational cannabis legalization, and eliminate state party primaries as we know them.

That the SJC is in such a role is, in itself, not new. But the deluge of proposals means the seven high-court justices are playing an even more significant role than usual in what is otherwise a political process.

Their decisions "can certainly upend the entire election," said Chris Keohan, a political consultant working on the campaign to reduce the state's income tax.

"We've had so few ballot questions [before] compara-

SJC, Page A7

World Cup parties on hold as towns stew

FIFA slow to grant licenses to show games outside

By Chris Serres, Michael Silverman, and Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

This spring, the Healey administration awarded \$10 million in grants to support World Cup celebrations in more than two dozen communities, hailing them as an opportunity for more people to share in the excitement without having to buy tickets to go to Gillette Stadium.

The party planners got to work: They imagined parks and town greens packed with soccer-crazed crowds, lined with food vendors, and anchored by towering screens broadcasting live World Cup matches in real time. The grants were intended to support World Cup-related celebrations in 25 cities and towns through June and July.

There's just one bottleneck: FIFA, soccer's powerful global governing body, has so far granted public viewing licenses to just two of the 17 organizations planning viewing events and other festivities, and with the start of the games fast approaching, it is unclear whether many of them will take place at all. Two municipalities have decided not to go forward with plans.

Without those approvals, municipalities cannot legally show the matches in public, leaving many local organizers frozen in place — unable to lock in vendors, rent giant screens, hire security, or recruit volunteers.

If the licenses do not come through soon, the vision of fans of diverse ethnicities and generations

WORLD CUP, Page B5

Our dirty little secret

Dunkin's taking Utah's favorite soda concoction to another level

By Devra First
GLOBE STAFF

Dunkin' done dirty sodas dirty.

The coffee chain just rolled out its own version of the drink-trend-gone-viral. In case you missed it, dirty sodas are a mix of soda with flavored syrups, creams, fruit purees, and other ingredients that first took root in the Mormon communities of Utah. Dunkin's version takes Pepsi, combines it with coffee milk, and tops it with sweet, creamy cold foam.

Could this in any way be a good idea? Is it safe? As a colleague said: "When you combine Pepsi and coffee, that does create a nuclear weapon, right?"

But believe it or not, the crime here is not one of taste. I ordered my dirty soda early in Dunkin's rollout, on my way home after dropping my son at school last week. The person behind the counter looked at me blankly when I ordered the new drink. I explained what was in it, and she laughed and shook her head. As someone began to concoct my unholy beverage, a little girl next to me holding her mother's hand gave me a look that plainly said, "You're ordering *soda* at 8:30 a.m.?" For research!

The Dunkin' dirty soda I received, size medium (\$4.49, 320

DIRTY SODA, Page A10



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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



Poured to tears

Thursday: Periods of rain. High 57-62. Low 47-52.

Friday: Cloudy and cool. High 53-58. Low 49-54.

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

The suspect in the Memorial Drive shooting had a turbulent history, and questions have been raised about his sentence in 2020. **B1.**

US intelligence agencies are saying behind closed doors that Iran has regained access to most of its missile sites, launchers, and underground facilities. **A3.**

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